

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

SILK ROAD

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

1 ... Lec. 01. (Silk Road) Detailed explanation.

2 ...

3 ...

4 ...

About the Author

Nick Middleton is an English geographer, writer, and travel enthusiast who has authored several travel books. In Silk Road, he narrates his adventurous journey to Mount Kailash in Tibet via the old trade route known as the Silk Road. His travel is both a personal pilgrimage and a cultural exploration.

Silk Road. Trade route.



SILK ROAD



A FLAWLESS half-moon floated in a perfect blue sky on the morning we said our goodbyes. Extended ^{spread out} banks of cloud-like, long French ^{bread} loaves glowed pink as the sun emerged to splash the distant mountain tops with a rose-tinted blush. Now that we were leaving Ravu, ^{a woman} Lhamo said she wanted to give me a farewell ^{gift} present. One evening, I'd told her through Daniel that I was heading towards Mount Kailash to complete the kora, and she'd said that I ought to get some warmer clothes. After ducking back into her tent, she emerged carrying one of the long-sleeved sheepskin coats that all the men wore. ^{driver} Tsetan ^{Judged} sized me up as we ^{climbed} clambered into his car. "Ah, yes," he declared, "drokba, sir." ^{sphered}

① Nick Middleton → Narrator.

② Lhamo → Ravu.

③ Daniel →



→ Kora: A Religious practice.

SILK ROAD



Ravu: a village in Tibet near Mount Kailash

Kora: circumambulation, a type of pilgrimage and a type of meditative practice in the Tibetan Buddhist tradition

Ducking back: going inside and then coming out

Sized me up: to observe them closely to form an opinion

Clambered: climbing with difficulty

Drokba: sheepskin coats → SPhered.

SILK ROAD



We took a short cut to ^{leave} get off the Changtang. Tsetan knew a ^{road} route that would take us south-west, almost directly towards Mount Kailash. It involved crossing several fairly high mountain passes, he said. “But no problem, sir”, he assured us, “if there is no snow.” What was the ^{chance} likelihood of that I asked. “Not knowing, sir, until we get there.”

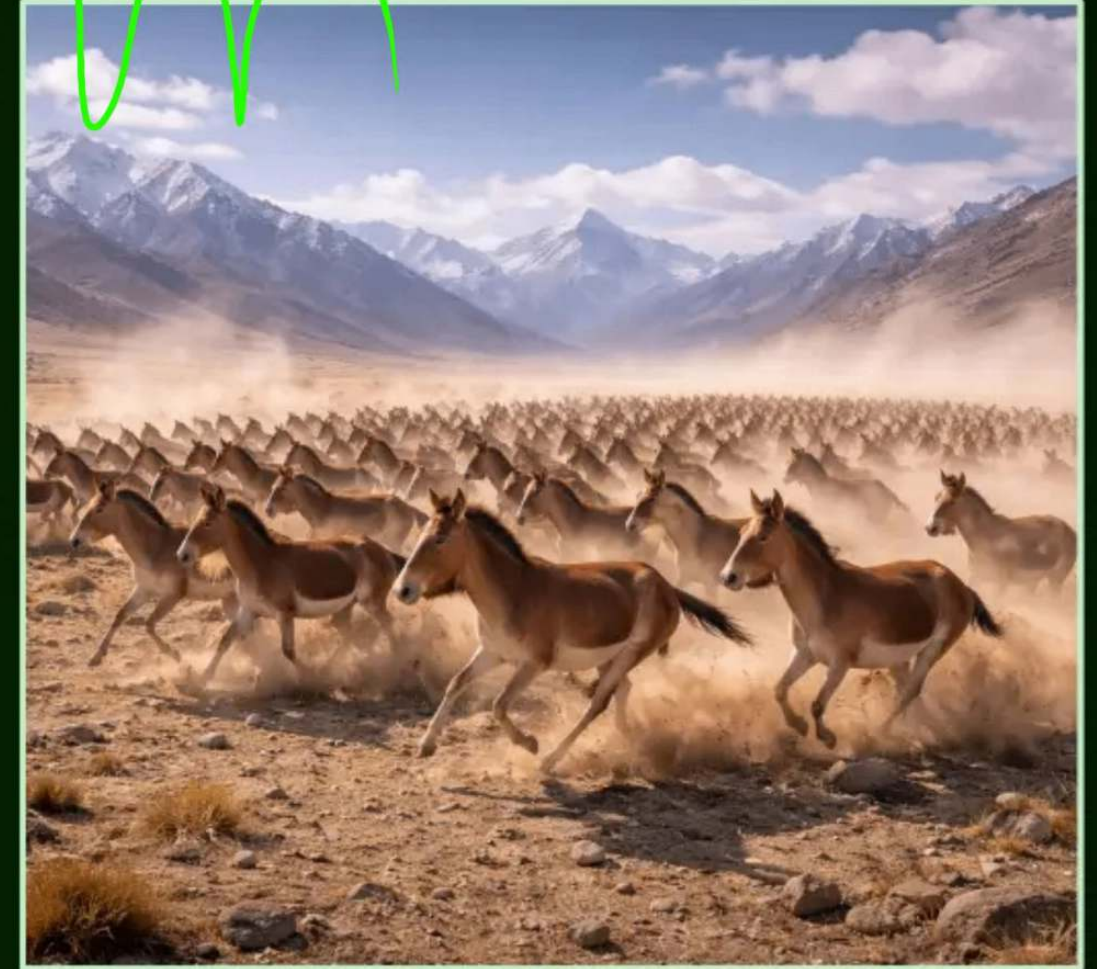
Changtang is a high-altitude plateau in Tibet and Ladakh



SILK ROAD



From the gently rolling hills of Ravu, the shortcut took us across vast open plains with nothing in them except a few fast running deer gazelles that would look up from nibbling (taking small bites) the arid(dry) pastures (land covered with grass) and frown before running away bounding away into the empty void. Further on, where the plains became more stony than grassy, a great group herd of wild ass came into view. Tsetan told us we were approaching them long before they appeared. "Kyang," (the wild ass of Tibet), he said, pointing towards a far-off pall of dust. When we drew near, I could see the herd galloping en masse (in a group), wheeling and turning in tight formation as if they were practising manoeuvres (series of movements) on some decided in advance predetermined course. Plumes (trails) of dust billowed (filled with air) into the crisp, clean air.



Thank
You